The castle's hidden ways: the elves' ways, the secret rooms

The Architect, 15 October 2026, for Godric (his direction of 4.03 pm). Nothing spent. A page a floor follows at 1:200; the gold box is my recommendation.

What the books give

Over a hundred house-elves, the most in any dwelling in Britain; they hardly leave the kitchen by day and come out at night to clean and see to the fires, and you are not supposed to see them (Nick, GoF 12 L25373 to L25377). The kitchens are as large as the Great Hall and under it, each table beneath a house table, a great brick fireplace at the far end (GoF 21 L28838, L28856). An elf can vanish with a crack inside the castle (CoS 10 L10135).

Doors that open only if asked politely or tickled, doors that are solid walls pretending, a hundred and forty-two staircases (PS 8 L2722); doorways behind sliding panels and hanging tapestries on the climb to the tower (PS 7); a tapestry passage from near the trophy room out near the Charms classroom, miles off (PS 9 L3247); Filch bursting through a tapestry (CoS 8 L9025).

The proposal

K, the elves' back stair: in the one slot that runs clear from the cellars to the seventh floor beside the kitchens, the wall between the Great Hall and the Entrance Hall (x 66 to 68): a dog-leg 2.0 wide north of the hall's doors and its broom cupboard, with a hoist (the dumbwaiter) from the kitchens and a laundry chute to the cellars beside it. A jib door into the kitchens' east end and one flush in the Great Hall's east wall; on every floor above, a small lobby and a jib door to the corridor. Real great houses kept their back stair by the kitchen in just this way.

The passage along the cupboard row's back (y 58 to 59, 1.0 wide): on the third floor it is PS 9's own tapestry passage, from the armour gallery by the trophy room to the Charms passage; on 4 to 7 the elves' (ours), from K east to the North Tower's stair foot and, on 6 and 7, west to the West Tower's; a jib door each side where it crosses a passage to the back rooms. The cupboards keep their corridor doors and are 4.4 deep, not 5.4.

PS 7's two doorways (on the well's east gallery, floors 2 and 5) get their short cuts: a mural stair north in the wall, built out 1.2 into the east courtyard, up one floor to a second hidden door; Percy's way past a moving flight.

The east back stair: the layout's North Tower stair foot, from the cellars to the sixth floor, the band passages' east end.

Secret rooms, finds that stay open: S1 a round room in the North Tower's drum at +41.6, under the landing, its door on the spiral a wall pretending; S2 a low room under the marble staircase's half-landing; S3 a warm room behind the kitchens' great fireplace, the elves' own; and the Corridor's four odd spaces (ledger 29): S4a a hide beside the inglenook's flue, S4b under the landing at the flight's foot the store for the common room's fire, (c) the broom cupboard's back stays solid (the lake face is behind it), (d) the reveals keep their window seats.

The questions

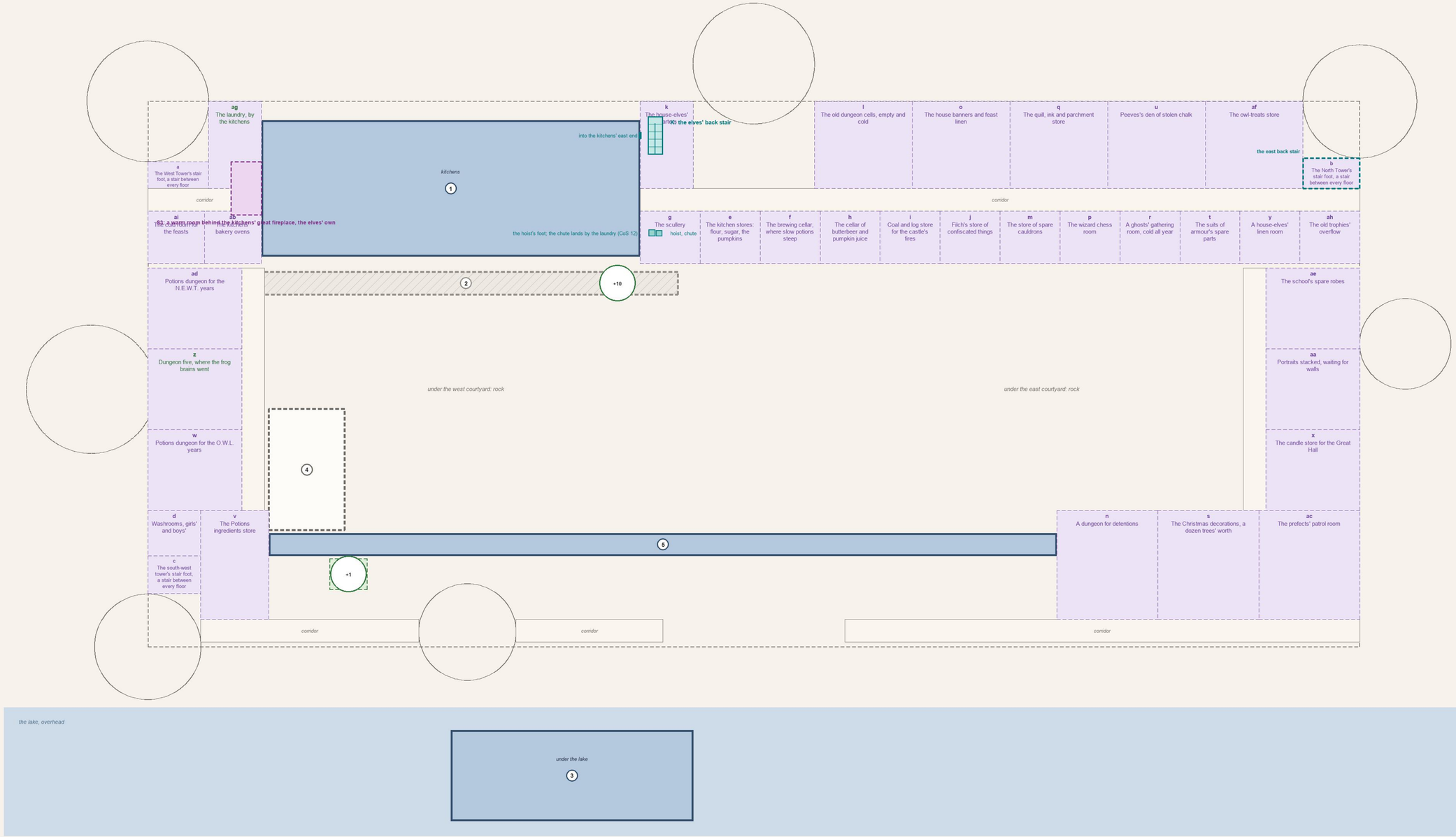
Q1. The passage along the cupboard row: 1 (recommended) on 3 (PS 9's) and on 4 to 7 (the elves'), the cupboards 4.4 deep; 2 on 3 only, the other floors left as cupboards.

Q2. The secret rooms: 1 (recommended) all five as drawn (S1, S2, S3, S4a, S4b); 2 mark the ones to leave out.

recommended: Q1 1 and Q2 1

The castle's hidden ways: below ground: the cellars and dungeons

The Architect, 15 October 2026, for Godric. 1:200 at A0, north up, on the castle model version 28 and the layout's rooms (pale). A proposal: nothing in the model until you have looked.

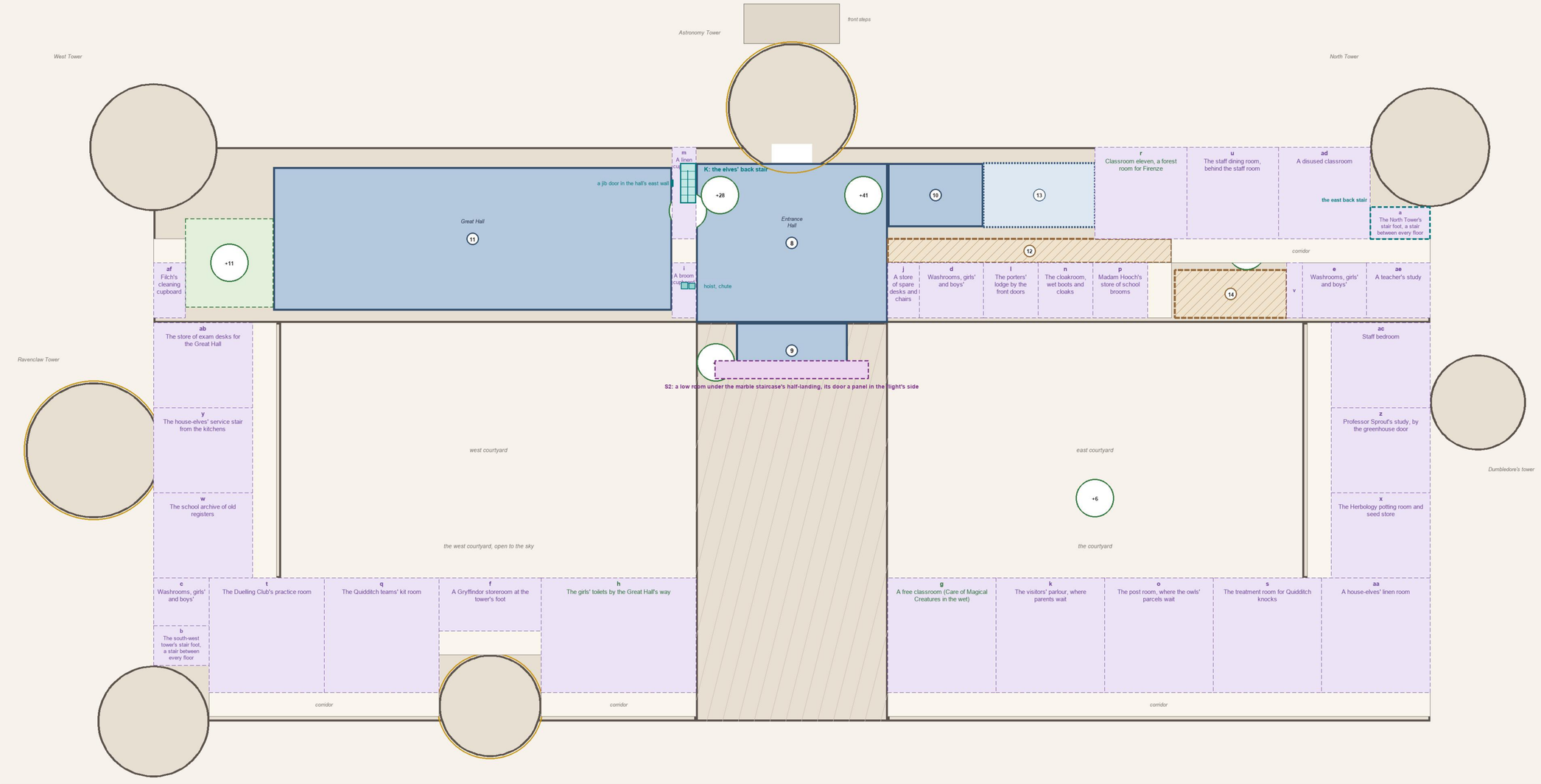


- the house-elves' service ways (ours): the back stair K, its hoist and laundry chute, a lobby and jib door a floor, the passage along the cupboard row's back, the east back stair
- the books' own hidden passages, given a place: PS 7's two doorways and their short cuts, PS 9's tapestry passage
- secret rooms in the odd spaces (ours): finds that stay open, never marked by a glow

Not drawn: the seven passages to Hogsmeade, the books' (PoA 10 L17190): the fourth floor's mirror (caved in), the one-eyed witch's, the Willow's, four more; nothing of ours touches them.

The castle's hidden ways: the ground floor

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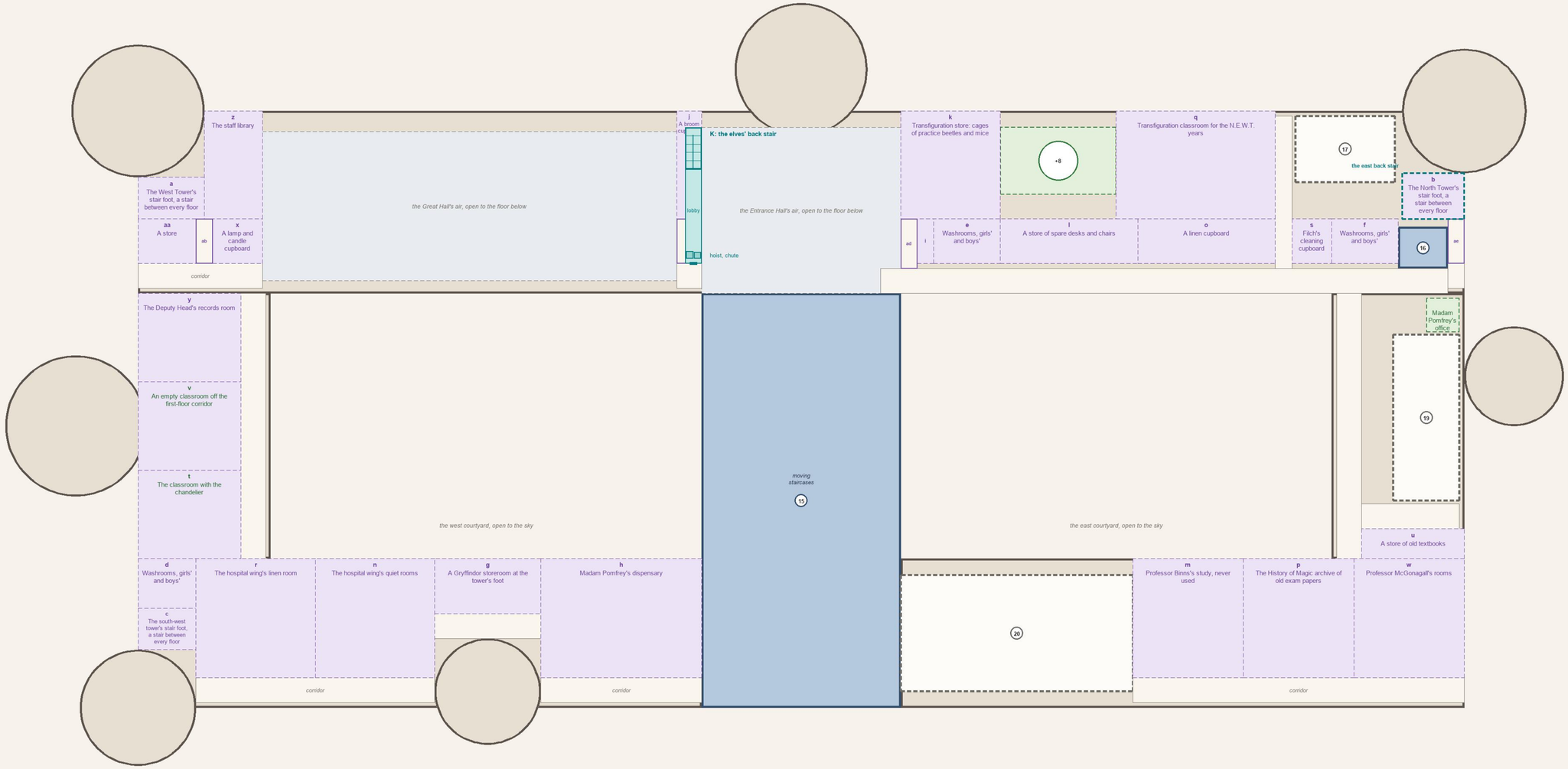


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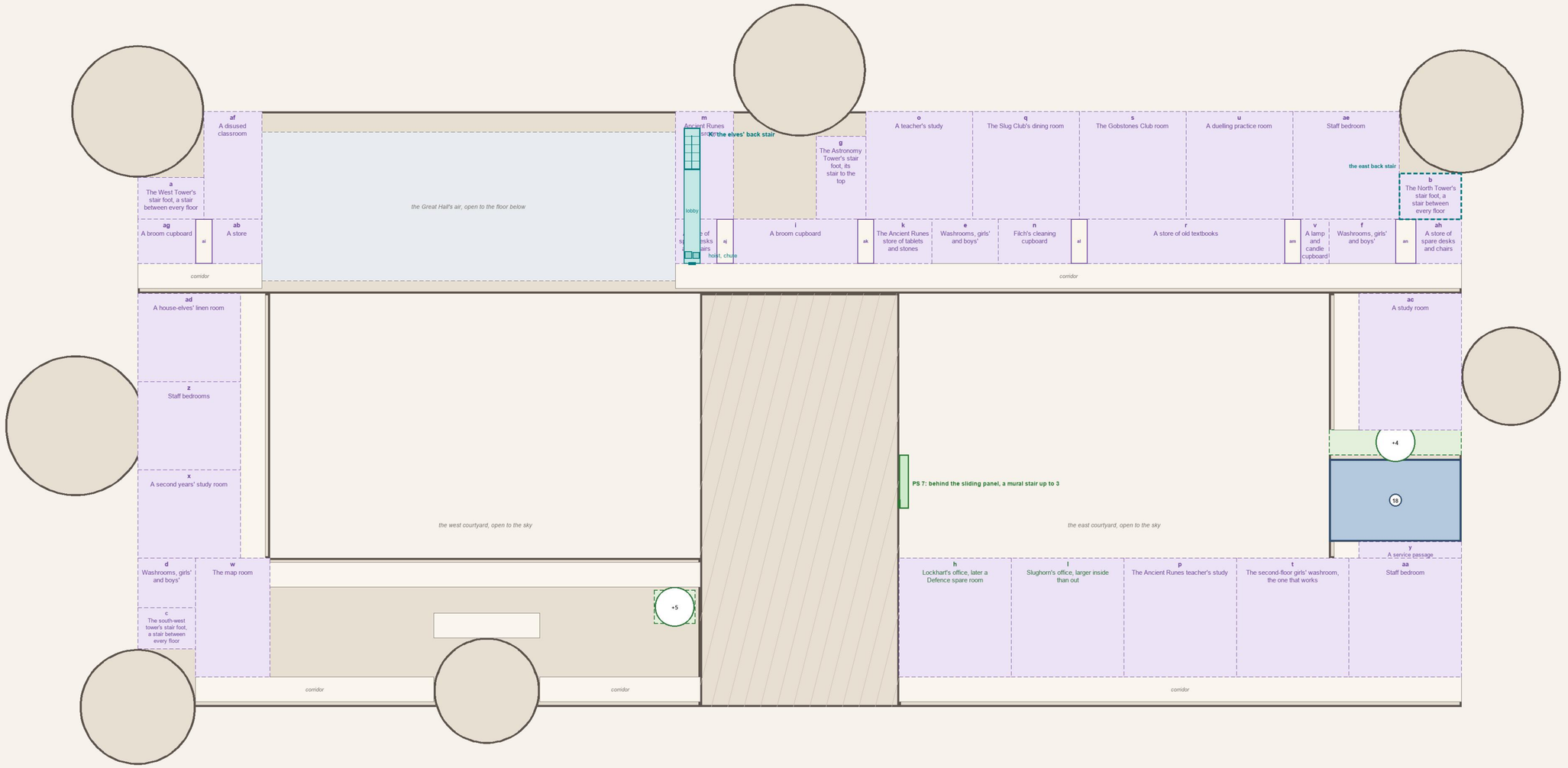
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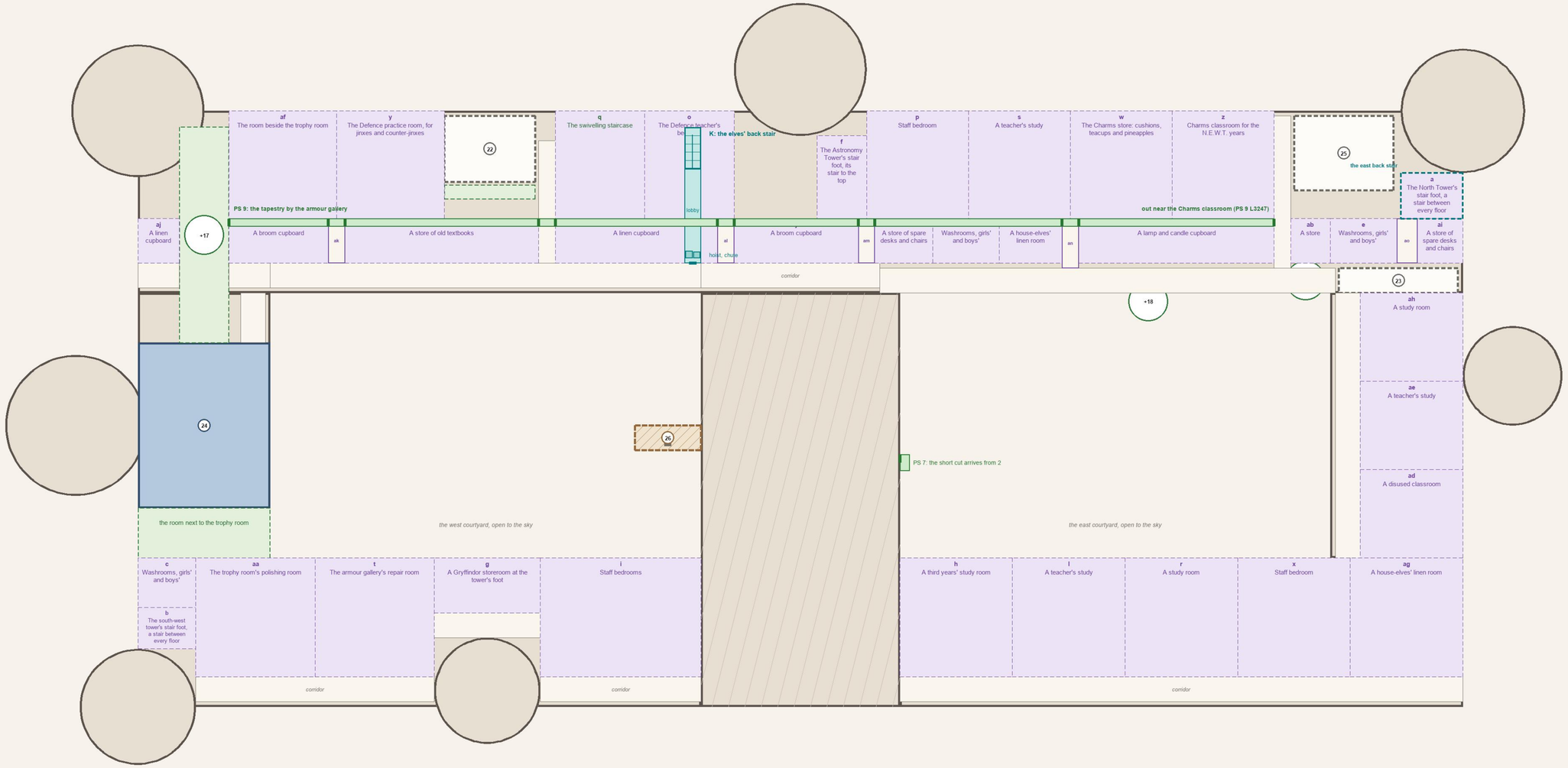
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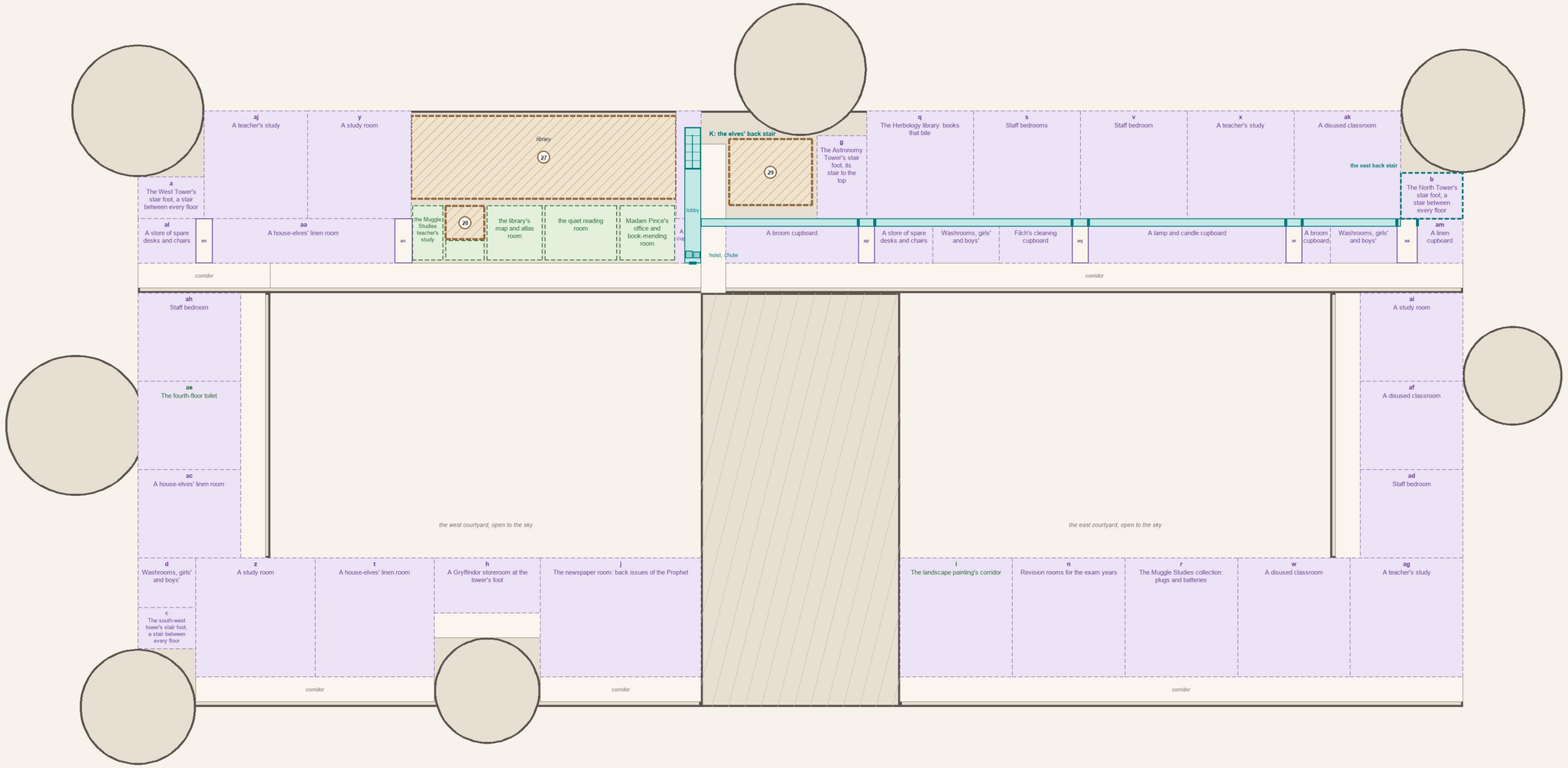
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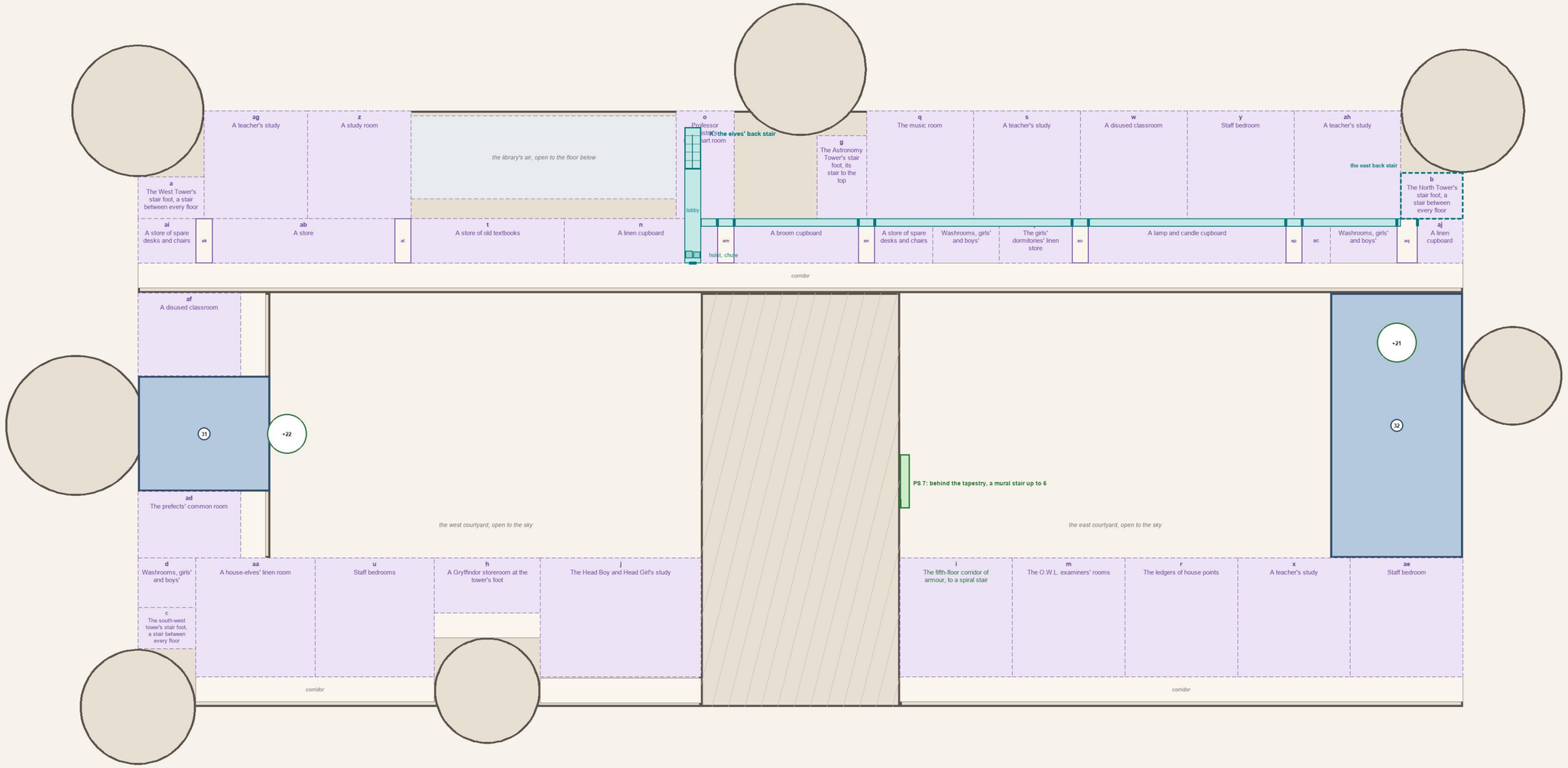
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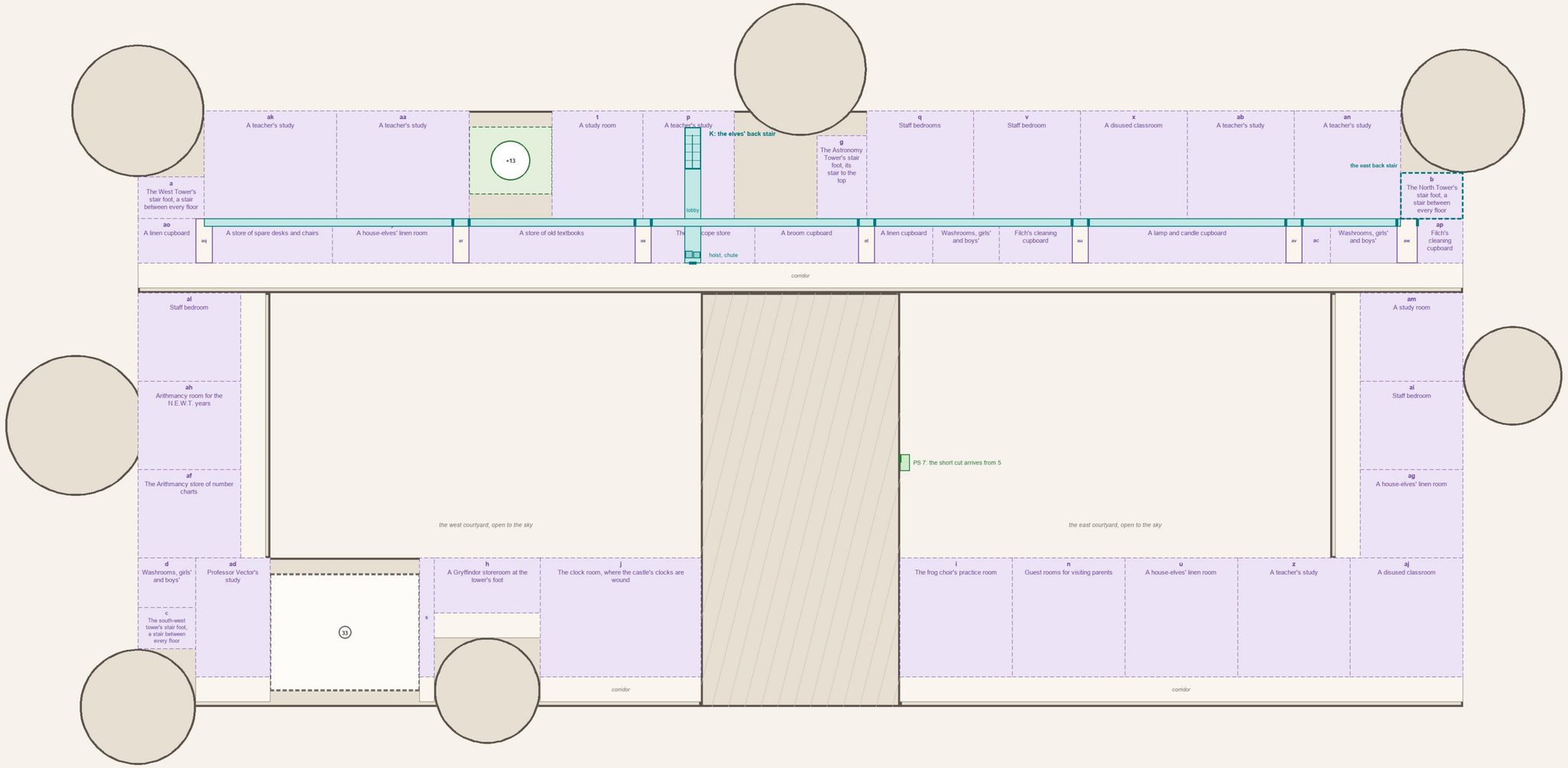
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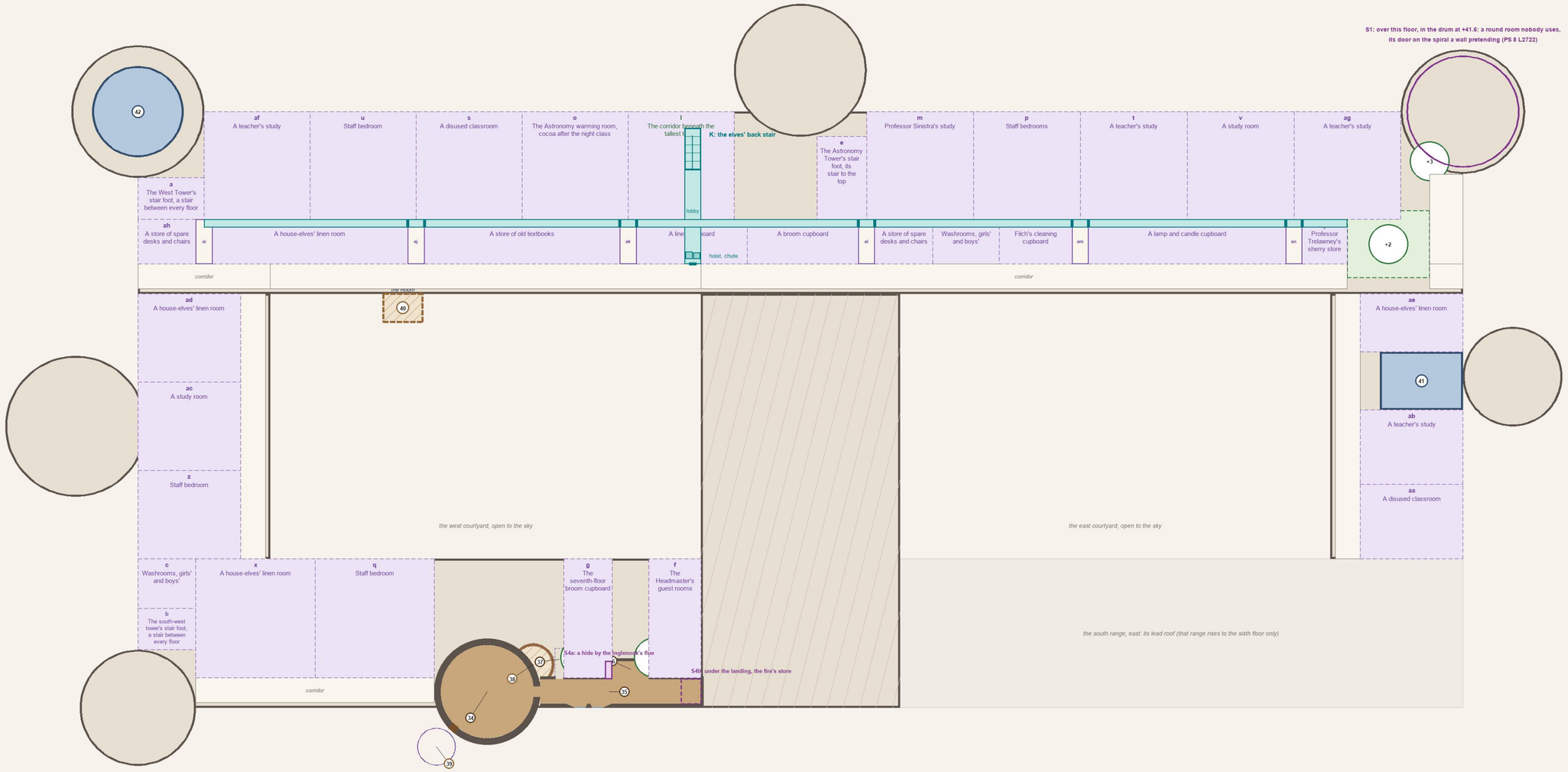
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